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H.U.G. MOTIVATIONAL MONDAY · OCTOBER 19, 2026

Build in public.
Trust yourself to figure it out.

In an AI world, the personal touch matters more.

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THE OPPORTUNITY TRAIL

What public work made possible



I wish I had started sooner

Shared the work	People could inspect how I contributed.
Joined the OpenClaw team	Public work created the opportunity.
Worked with GitHub	Hosted an event and recorded a video and podcast.
More invitations followed	About a dozen speaking engagements and appearances.

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THE AI FUTURE GETS MORE PERSONAL

Personal brand is accumulated evidence

What do people expect from you before you enter the room?

- Useful work
- Visible corrections
- Community contribution

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BUILDING IN PUBLIC

Share the failures too

01

What I tried

02

What happened

03

What I changed

People recognize their own setbacks in yours. The correction shows how you respond.

GIVE BACK WITHOUT KEEPING SCORE

Community changes the work

Help someone.
Teach what you know.
Show up when hands are needed.



> Community work exposes you to people and problems outside your bubble. Those relationships outlast any platform.

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IDEAS I RETURN TO

Three books. Three practices.

Meditations	Marcus Aurelius	**Consistency**
Nuts!	Kevin and Jackie Freiberg	**Why not?**
Leaders Eat Last	Simon Sinek	**Serve first**

> **"Waste no more time arguing what a good man should be. Be one."**
>
> Marcus Aurelius, Meditations 10.16

▼ Sources

- Meditations — Marcus Aurelius
- Nuts!: Southwest Airlines' Crazy Recipe for Business and Personal Success — Kevin Freiberg and Jackie Freiberg
- Leaders Eat Last: Why Some Teams Pull Together and Others Don't — Simon Sinek

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FAITH IN YOUR ABILITY TO FIGURE THINGS OUT

Confidence needs a process

Learn enough

Use AI to learn the language.

Ask better questions

Find the people who know the work.

Try something small

Make the next step reviewable.

Check the result

Let evidence and experts correct you.

HOW WE APPROACH CUSTOMER PROBLEMS

Empathy before implementation

“Show me how the work happens today.”

Customers usually describe a symptom. The people doing the work reveal the real problem.



McKinsey & Company for geeks

Consulting curiosity close enough to build and verify the solution.

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A FICTIONAL BAKERY CHALLENGE

I know code.
I don't know dough.



THE PROBLEM

Favorites sell out. Other bread goes unsold.

LEARN BEFORE BUILDING

Use AI to learn the business. Ask the baker what the sales data misses.

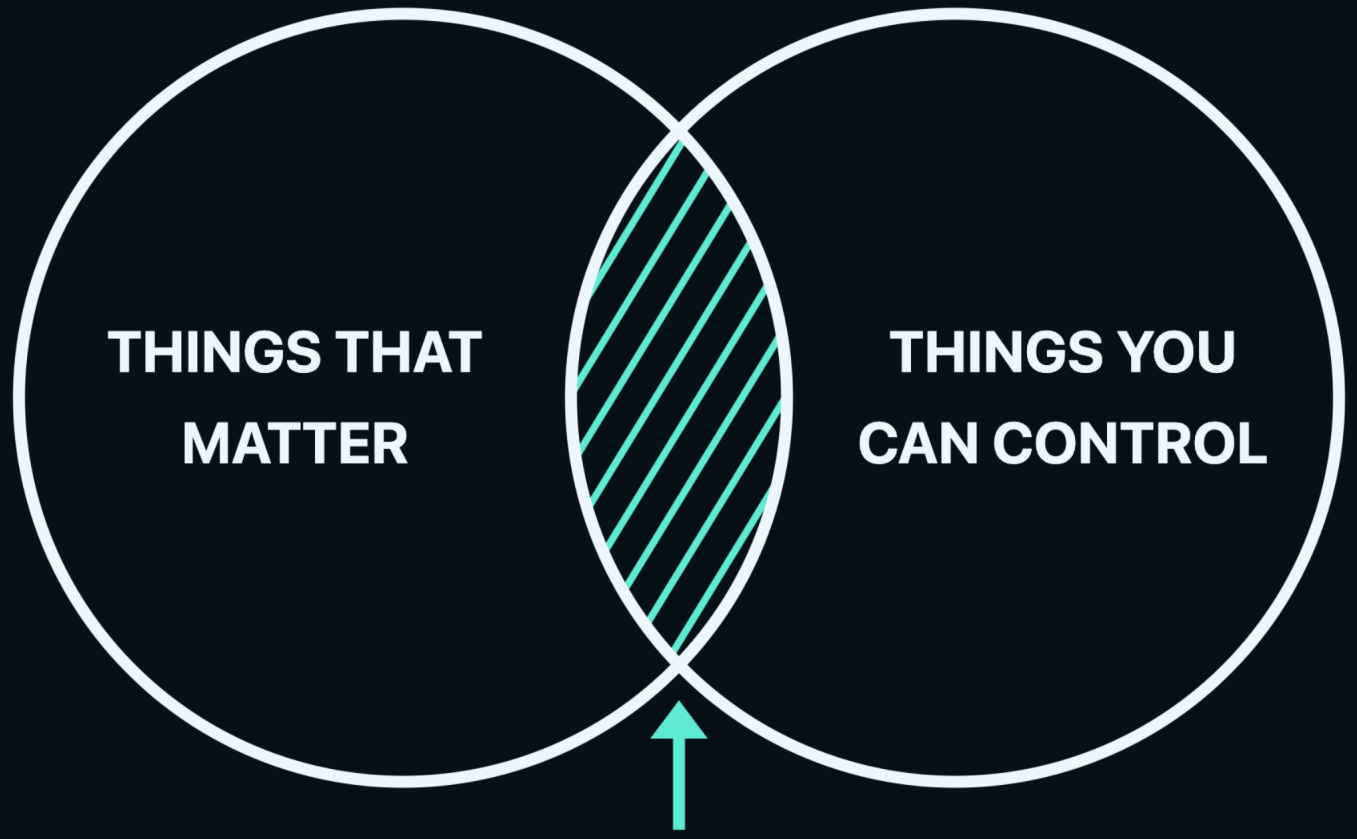
THE SMALL TEST

Recommend tomorrow's bake quantities. The baker reviews. Track waste and sellouts.

The baker knows dough. You bring a way to test the next batch.

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THE OVERLAP



WHAT YOU SHOULD FOCUS ON

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ERIC THOMAS · THE HIP HOP PREACHER

How badly do you want it?

“When you want to succeed as bad as you want to breathe, then you'll be successful.”

> Desire is fuel. Process gives it direction.

▼ Sources

- Eric Thomas — official site
- Eric Thomas: How Bad Do You Want It? — speech video

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YOUR NEXT MOVE

One useful thing this week

Publish something you learned, made, or corrected.

Put it where people in your field can find it.



If I can do this, you can do this.
Start small, think big.

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FOR NEW MEMBERS ATTENDING TODAY

Your first year of SSTB.ai is on us.



Start Small, Think Big.

Keep learning, building, and sharing with the SSTB community.

No payment card required.
365 days of membership access.

Redeem by **October 21, 8 PM Central.**
Use the email approved at event check-in.

Scan to claim your year.

go.sstb.ai/hug2026

New members · approved attendees only